

Amendment No. 1 to HB2114

Crawford
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 2450

House Bill No. 2114*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1.

(a) The Tennessee advisory commission on intergovernmental relations (TACIR) shall conduct a study to determine if newspapers of general circulation remain the most efficient and effective manner for governments to provide the public with transparent and accessible information, including:

(1) How the efficiencies of the methods of public notice have changed historically;

(2) How the public has obtained its news and information historically versus today, including how the number of newspapers has changed in Tennessee, how the frequency of their publication has changed, and if the number of subscribers as a percentage of the population has changed historically;

(3) Examining the ability of government entities to create public notice systems, including their ability to maintain permanent public archiving, protect the corruption of data, and have independent verification of publication;

(4) Reviewing the costs associated with government entities maintaining online public notice platforms;

(5) Reviewing all governmental and public entities to determine how much tax payer money is used to meet newspaper publication requirements in the state;

(6) Examining whether citizens should be required to pay a subscription fee to access information that is intended to provide notice and transparency of government actions; and

(7) Reviewing public notice practices in other states and any trends or advances in technology that are available, including whether any new practices have had any effect on transparency, government accountability, impacts to rural communities, or civic participation in those states.

(b) TACIR may request information and input from other states and state and local governmental entities, as necessary, and such entities in this state shall comply with TACIR's request. The study must be conducted from within TACIR's existing resources.

(c) Upon completion of the study, TACIR shall report its findings and recommendations, including any proposed legislation, to the chair of the state and local government committee of the senate and the chair of the committee of the house of representatives having jurisdiction over subject matters pertaining to state and local government, and provide a copy of the report to the legislative librarian. The report must be submitted no later than January 31, 2027, and may be delivered electronically.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.